

Petition 1 — Enhancement of Agricultural Electricity Connection to 5 HP for Deep Borewells in the Chittur Rain-Shadow Belt

To: Shri Sunny Joseph Hon'ble Minister for Electricity, Government of Kerala Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: 1. Shri T. Siddique, Hon'ble Minister for Agriculture 2. Shri Mons Joseph, Hon'ble Minister for Water Resources (Irrigation & Ground Water)

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Request to (a) grant agricultural electricity connections for deep irrigation borewells in the rain-shadow panchayats of Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy, Kozhinjampara and adjoining areas of the Chittur block **directly through KSEB, without any involvement of the Ground Water Authority**, and (b) permit and expedite such connections up to **5 HP** (and, where justified, above 5 HP).

1. Respected Sir,

We are farmer-representatives of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara. We respectfully place before you the acute irrigation-power difficulty faced by the farmers of the eastern, rain-shadow part of the Chittur Assembly constituency, and pray for your intervention.

2. The factual position

- 1. Kerala's driest belt.** Chittur — and in particular Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara — lies in the Palakkad Gap **rain-shadow region**, the driest tract in Kerala. Annual rainfall here is only about **1,000 mm (and often less)**, against the State average of roughly **3,000 mm** — barely **one-third** of the State average. The surrounding hills block the rain-bearing winds.
- 2. A "Critical" groundwater block.** As per the Central Ground Water Board's *National Compilation on Dynamic Ground Water Resources of India (2023 and 2024)*, **Chittur is one of only two or three "Critical" groundwater blocks in the entire State of Kerala** (along with Malampuzha and Kasaragod), where the stage of groundwater extraction is between 90% and 100%.
- 3. Deepening borewells.** Because surface water is scarce and rainfall is low, farmers depend almost entirely on borewells. Water tables have fallen steeply — borewells that were once 400–600 ft now increasingly **cross 800–1,000 ft** in these panchayats.
- 4. The power bottleneck — the exact legal position.** Following the groundwater regime tightened after the Plachimada (Perumatty panchayat) bottling-plant water controversy: - Under the **Kerala Ground Water (Control and Regulation) Act, 2002 (Act 19 of 2003)** and the **Kerala Ground Water (Control and Regulation) Rules, 2004**, the Government, exercising powers under **Section 6(1)**, notified certain areas as "notified areas." By **G.O.(P) No. 58/2005/WRD dated 19-11-2005, Chittoor (Palakkad District) was declared a notified area** (along with Athiyannur, Kodungalloor, Kozhikode and Kasaragode). - Consequently, under **Section 7** of the Act, extraction of groundwater in Chittoor requires a **permit from the Kerala State Ground Water Authority**. - By **KSEB Board Circular dated 05-06-2007 (Circular_Control_05-06-2007)**, the Board directed that an **electric connection to any open well / borewell within a notified area shall be given only on production of the Ground Water Authority permit**, treating that permit as a statutory clearance — in line with the proviso to **Clause 6(1) of the Kerala Electricity Supply Code** (now the **Kerala Electricity Supply Code, 2014**). - Under the Ground Water Department's operating practice, the **District-level committee sanctions motors only in the 3–5 HP band**, and motors **above 5 HP require State-level authority** approval, so in practice farmers in this belt are

effectively held at around **3 HP**, with long delays for anything higher. - Further, before the borewell / EB line is approved, the **Ground Water Authority requires the farmer to install a water flow meter on the well and submit its readings**, and grants the extraction/conversion permit **subject to a ceiling on daily extraction** fixed on the basis of a **yield test**. In our critical-zone belt these flow-meter, daily-log and yield-test conditions are difficult and impractical for small and marginal farmers to comply with and add further delay to obtaining the EB connection.

5. **Why 3 HP is not enough.** A 3 HP pump simply cannot lift adequate water from a borewell that is 800–1,000 ft deep. The result is that farms cannot be irrigated even where a valid well exists, causing crop loss and distress among paddy, banana, coconut and vegetable growers who have no alternative source of water.

3. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister to:

1. **Remove the Ground Water Authority from the electric-connection process altogether.** The Ground Water Authority shall **not be involved at all** in granting an agricultural EB connection for a borewell in these panchayats. Accordingly, the requirement — under the **KSEB Board Circular dated 05-06-2007** — that a Ground Water Authority permit be produced as a pre-condition for the connection should be **withdrawn / relaxed** for agricultural connections in the Chittur belt, so that **KSEB grants the connection directly** without any reference to the Ground Water Authority.
2. **Sanction agricultural EB connections up to 5 HP as the norm** for genuine cultivators in Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy, Kozhinjampara (and comparable areas of Chittur block) where the certified borewell depth exceeds a reasonable threshold (e.g. 500/800 ft), **directly by KSEB** on a simple application and well-depth certificate.
3. **Expedite connections above 5 HP** in genuinely deep borewells, on the basis of a well-depth certificate, **without any Ground Water Authority reference** and without routine referral delays.
4. Since the Ground Water Authority is not to be involved, the **flow-meter, daily-log and yield-test conditions** presently imposed by the Authority **shall not apply as a pre-condition** to the agricultural EB connection.
5. **Retain the concessional LT-VA agricultural tariff** for these enhanced-HP irrigation connections.
6. **Ease the permission to install a TT (changeover) switch.** Every agricultural motor is now fitted with a **smart meter** that automatically detects and notifies any overshoot of the sanctioned HP limit, for which a **penalty is levied**. This automatic safeguard makes the earlier restrictive approach to TT / changeover-switch permission unnecessary. At present, obtaining **TT-switch permission for a free / subsidised agricultural EB connection is difficult and time-consuming**. We request that the process of granting **TT-switch (changeover-switch) permission be simplified and eased**, since any excess use is in any case automatically detected and penalised by the smart meter.
7. Consider **dedicated agricultural feeders / assured three-phase supply hours** for the belt so that deep-borewell irrigation is reliable (paired with drip/micro-irrigation).

We are willing to furnish panchayat-wise lists of affected farmers, borewell-depth data and pending connection applications.

4. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Panchayat-wise list of affected farmers and pending/limited connections.
- Annexure B: Borewell depth certificates / sample.
- Annexure C: CGWB categorisation extract for Chittur block.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur

Annexure — Draft Government Order (model, for the Government's consideration)

The following is a model draft placed for the Government's consideration. The actual G.O. number, date and file references are to be assigned by the Department.

GOVERNMENT OF KERALA
Abstract

Power (Electricity) Department — Agricultural electric connections for deep bore-wells in Chittoor block, Palakkad District — De-linking the connection from the Ground Water Authority permit and enhancing permissible motor capacity up to 5 HP — Sanctioned — Orders issued.

POWER (ELECTRICITY) DEPARTMENT
G.O.(Ms) No. ____/2026/PD Thiruvananthapuram, dated __-__-2026

Read: 1. The Kerala Ground Water (Control and Regulation) Act, 2002
(Act 19 of 2003) and Rules, 2004.
2. G.O.(P) No. 58/2005/WRD dated 19-11-2005 (notified areas).
3. KSEB Board Circular dated 05-06-2007.
4. Representation dated 15-07-2026 of the Chittur Agriculture
Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, forwarded by the MLA, Chittur.

ORDER

Whereas Chittoor block is a notified area under the Act read above (2) and one of the "Critical" ground-water blocks of the State; and whereas bore-wells in Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara now commonly exceed 800–1,000 ft, for which a 3 HP pump-set is technically insufficient;

Government, having considered the matter, hereby order that —

- (1) the requirement under the Circular read above (3) — that a Ground Water Authority permit be produced as a pre-condition — shall NOT apply to agricultural connections in the said panchayats; the Ground Water Authority shall not be involved in the grant of such connections;
- (2) KSEB Ltd. shall sanction agricultural (LT-VA) connections up to 5 HP directly, as a matter of course, to genuine cultivators in the said panchayats on a simple application and well-depth certificate, where the certified bore-well depth exceeds [500/800] ft;
- (3) applications for connections above 5 HP for genuinely deep bore-wells shall be disposed by KSEB within [30] days on the basis of a well-depth certificate, without any Ground Water Authority reference;
- (4) accordingly, the Ground Water Authority's flow-meter, daily-log and yield-test conditions shall not apply as a pre-condition to the EB line;
- (5) the concessional LT-VA agricultural tariff shall continue to apply;
- (6) the process for grant of permission to install a TT / change-over switch for agricultural connections shall be simplified and eased, since the smart meter now automatically detects and penalises any overshoot of the sanctioned HP; and
- (7) the Department shall examine dedicated agricultural feeders for the belt.

By order of the Governor,

Secretary to Government

To The Chairman & Managing Director, KSEB Ltd.
The Member Secretary, Kerala State Ground Water Authority.
Copy to: Agriculture Dept.; Water Resources Dept.; the MLA, Chittur.